	IMPARTIALITY POLICY	
	Document no: ASMF4.2	
Compiled by:	**Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager**	
Approved by:	**Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager**	

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IMPARTIALITY POLICY

Introduction

This policy ensures the commitment of Azuresky to upholding the highest standards in impartiality, independence and objectivity in all its activities as a reference material producer and proficiency testing scheme provider as stipulated in ISO 17025, ISO 17043 and ISO 17034.

Scope

This policy applies to management, employees, contractors gazetted in the testing, production and distribution of reference materials and as providers of proficiency testing scheme.

Mission Statement

Impartiality is a core principle and is essential in ensuring the credibility of an organisation involved in the production of reference materials and provider of proficiency testing scheme. To address this, top management commits themselves to the following:

- Identifying and managing risks to impartiality, including conflicts of interest, undue influence, undue pressure, be it financial or commercial.
- Ensuring independence between production, testing, evaluation, and decision-making processes.
- Maintaining transparency, objectivity, and confidentiality in its operations.
- Separating responsibilities to avoid bias.
- Technical independence free from commercial pressure, mandated to remain objective and neutral with providing technical expertise in reviewing and processing of data.
- Taking corrective actions if impartiality is compromised or threatened.

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Commitment to remaining autonomous

To ensure independence and objectivity and protect impartiality risks within us as an organization and from any outside influence, the following needs to be enforced:

- Continuous mandatory disclosure of conflicts of interests
- Separate commercial functions from technical decision-making, ensuring that financial pressures do not affect scientific integrity.
- Disclosure of incentives from clients and registering them in the incentive register form (This is to protect personnel from any undue pressure in the organisations' activities.)

Responsibilities

Managing directors and Operations managers' responsibility is to safeguard impartiality and provide sufficient resources to maintain independence.

Laboratory Managers/Supervisors' responsibility is to monitor and oversee impartiality risk and come up with plans to mitigate any that may arise.

All personnel are to adhere to this policy and report any potential impartiality concerns.

Reviews and communication

The policy is to be reviewed annually via a committee with the following present, top management representative as defined in the organogram

The policy must be communicated as part of induction procedures to new employees and annual communication made to personnel.

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